

Impact High · Difficulty Easy-Medium · Misuse risk It fails when the request stays vague ("Can you help?") or turns to pressure

THE MOVE

I'm finalising the plan by Friday. Could you review the one-page version by Thursday afternoon? Even a yes/no on option B would help. -> Could you send me the exact address before 5 pm so I can book the transport? -> No pressure if yo...

START HERE

Ask for the exact action and timeframe: "Could you do X by Y?"

SAY THIS

Core ask	"Could you do X by Y?"
Professional	"Could you review the one-page summary by Thursday?"
Digital / text	"Quick ask: could you reply yes/no by Friday?"
High-status / busy people	"To make this easy to respond to, the ask is..."
Low-pressure / social	"Only if it is easy."
Leadership / delegation	"The outcome I need is..."

AVOID

- You have not yet worked out what you actually want
- You need consent or buy-in before assigning any action
- The other person needs safety, privacy, silence or practical help, not a task

REMEMBER

If the other person has to translate your request into an action, the request is not clean.